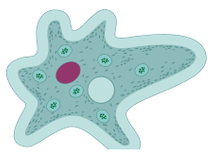
- ❖ It provides the information about living things in different geographical regions.
- ❖ It helps in understanding how complex organisms must have evolved from simpler ones.

Scientists have been able to discover and classify more than 2 million organisms on the earth ranging from tiny bacteria to the largest blue whales. Each organism has been classified in a category based on its evolutionary relationship with other group of organisms. We can define hierarchy of organisms as:

"The system of arranging taxonomic categories in a descending order based on their relationships with other group of organism is called **hierarchy of categories"**. This system was introduced by Linnaeus and is called **Linnaean hierarchy.** There are seven main categories of hierarchies namely, **Kingdom, Phylum, Class, Order, Family, Genus and Species.** Species is the basic unit of classification

Based on the above classification the following table shows different phylum, with general features and examples of different phyla and classes

S. NO	General Characters	Division
1	Microscopic unicellular, pseudopodia, flagella and cilia for locomotion, reproduce by fission or conjugation.	Phylum **Protozoa** Eg. *Amoeba, Euglena* and *Paramoecium* 
2	Multicellular organisms with holes in the body. Skeleton formed of spicules, asexual and sexual reproduction.	**Phylum Porifera** E*g. Leucosolenia, Spongilla, Sycon.* 
3	Multicellular organisms Diploblastic, sessile or free swimming, solitary or colonial, asexual and sexual reproduction	Phylum **Coelenterata** Eg. Hydra, Sea anemone, Jelly fish, Corals. 
4	Acoelomates, parasites inside the body of animals and human beings, mostly hermaphrodite (bisexual).	Phylum **Platyhelminthes** Eg. *Planaria*, Liver fluke , Blood fluke, Tapeworm 
5	Unsegmented body, mostly parasites in human beings and animals, causing diseases, asexual reproduction.	Phylum **Aschelminthes** or Nematoda Eg. *Ascaris lumbricoides* 
6	Triploblastic, segmented body, mostly hermaphrodite (bisexual and unisexual).	**Phylum Annelida** Eg. Earthworm, Nereis, Leech. 

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